



NO. 03 · AUTUMN 2025

VOID DISPATCH

Void Dispatch is a zine about cities, infrastructure, and the systems we live inside. Free to read. Free to print. Free to leave somewhere.

Contributing writers: Dana Ferris, M. Okafor,
T. Nakamura, S. Reyes, P. Voss.

Printed on whatever you have.

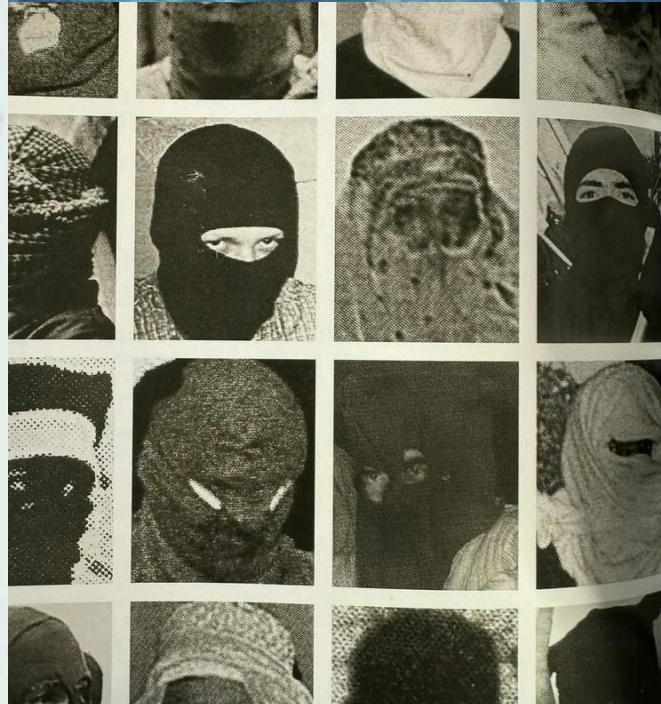
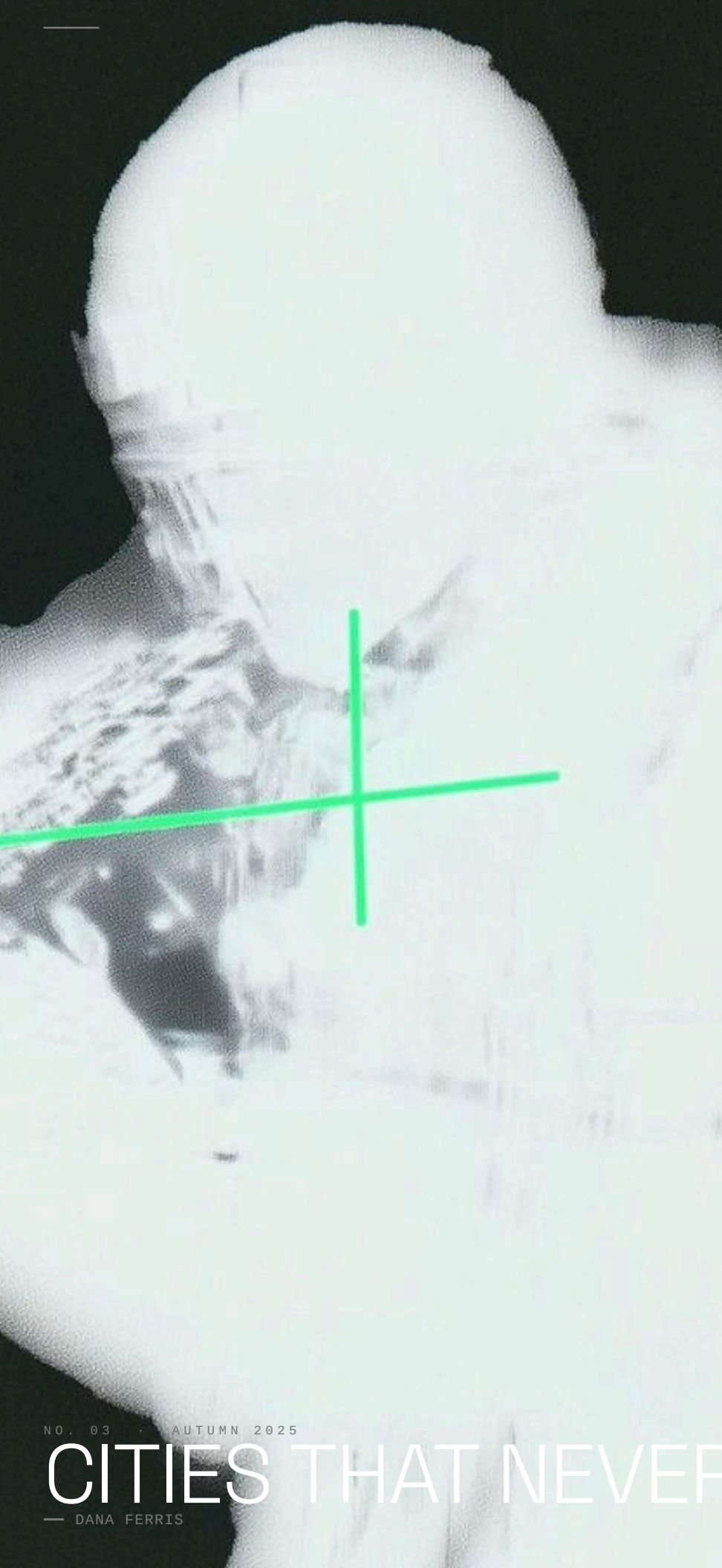
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VOID DISPATCH

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 - 2 _____ THREE WAYS TO DISAPPEAR
 - 3 _____ THE LAST PAYPHONE
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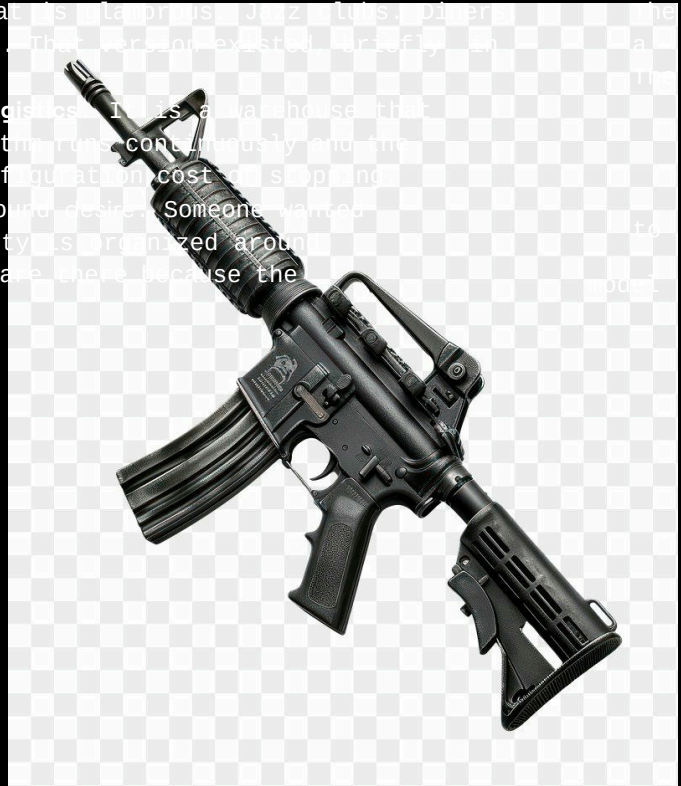
CITIES THAT NEVER SLEEP

— DANA FERRIS

CITIES THAT NEVER SLEEP

— DANA FERRIS

There is a version of the 24-hour city that is late nights, jazz clubs, diner, the last bus home and someone interesting on it. That version existed briefly in a handful of places, and it was good. The version we have now is different. It is logistics. It is a warehouse that cannot go dark because the sortation algorithm runs continuously and the humans inside it are cheaper than the reconfiguration costs. Someone wanted to be there at 3am. The logistical 24-hour city is organized around throughput. No one wants to be there. They are there because the city requires it.



"/ "FULFILLMENT CENTER, OUTER RING ROAD

QUOTE

The lights are always on here. That used to mean something.

— OUTSIDE A FULFILLMENT CENTER, 3:14AM



It is the distinction that city planners, when they invoke "vibrancy," consistently fail to make. Vibrancy is not a property of illuminated windows. It is a property of people choosing to be somewhere.

We built infrastructure for the night and called it nightlife. We built coverage for every hour and called it community. We lit every corner and called these substitutions are neutral.

A city that cannot sleep is not
awake. It is running a process.



NOVEMBER 2025

THREE WAYS TO DISAPPEAR

THREE WAYS TO DISAPPEAR

— M. OKAFOR



"/ "ANALOG, UNCONNECTED

Method two: reduce identity surface area. You have more than you need. Some are attached to your real name, number, a payment method, a device fingerprint. There is not deactivation. It is to stop creating new ones. Every new account is a new exposure surface.

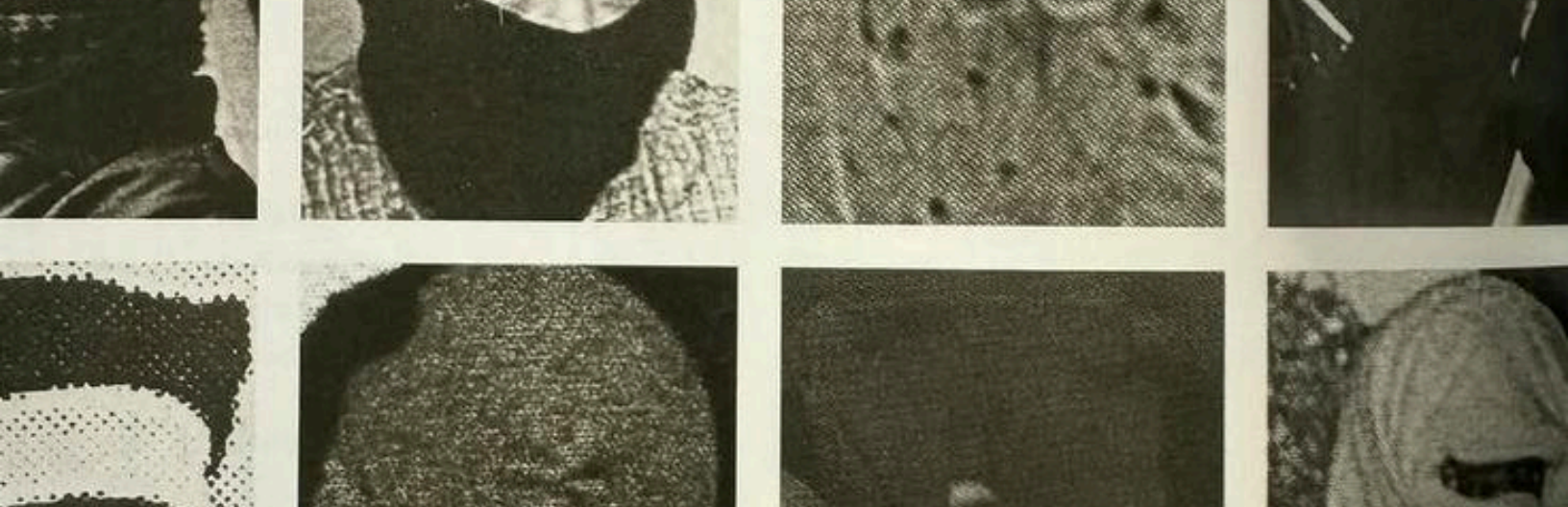
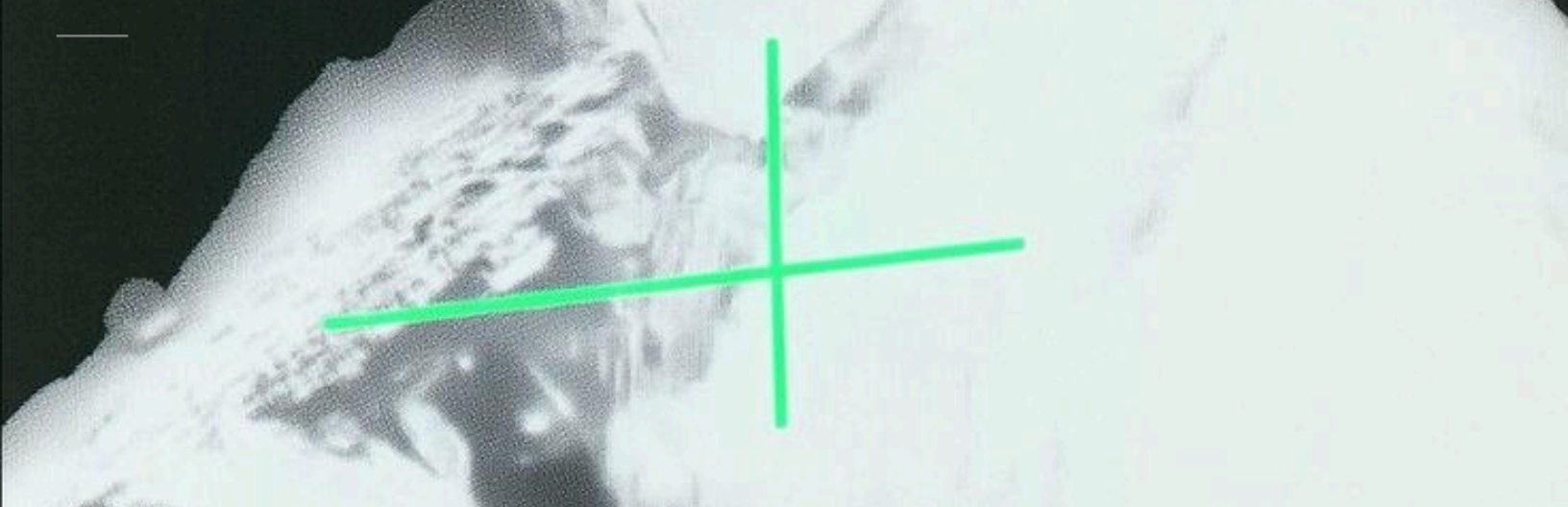
Method three: make boring choices visible. Notice when you are making a choice. Not every choice requires a different decision. But many defaults were set by someone whose interests are not yours. Default on: location sharing, cross-app tracking, personalized ads. Reversing these – not in every case, just deliberately – changes what flows through the pipes.

practice piece. Paranoia assumes a specific condition and responds to it. It assumes a general condition and responds to it. **Method one: go analog for the boring stuff.** Most of life is passive and opportunistic. It collects information through the pipes. A notebook does not have a policy. A pocket calendar does not sync to a cloud. Shopping lists, personal notes, appointments – these are things people you trust – none of these need a network.



THE ACTUAL THREAT MODEL

You are probably not being targeted specifically. You are in a database being queried by systems with no opinion about you as a person. The goal is not to escape the database. The goal is to make the query less useful.



THE LAST PAYPHONE

MAY 2005 AUTUMN 2005

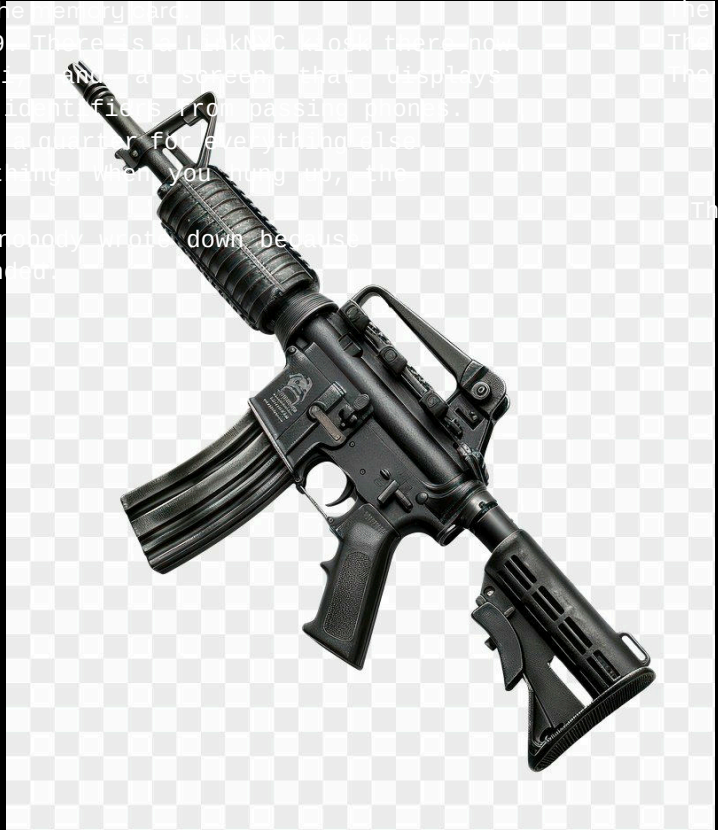
— T. NAKAMURA

-- ARTICLE

THE LAST PAYPHONE

— T. NAKAMURA

A photo essay without photos, because we lost the emergency kiosk on Delancey and Essex was removed in 2019. There is still a kiosk, but now the kiosk offers free calls, fast Wi-Fi, and a screen that displays advertisements. It also collects device identifiers from passing phones. The kiosk offered free emergency calls and required a quarter for emergency calls. It collected nothing. It remembered nothing. When you hung up, the conversation was over. This was not a bug. This was a feature that nobody worried about because nobody thought it would need to be defended.



"/ "DELANCEY AND ESSEX, 2019

QUOTE

You could call anyone and they couldn't call you back unless they already knew where you were.

— A PERSON WHO REMEMBERED THE QUARTER



York City was removed from a hotel lobby in 2022. It is now in a museum. Which is the correct place for things that society no longer needs, and which is also the correct place to feel the specific grief of infrastructure loss.

The kiosk is faster. The kiosk is free. The kiosk is always available. The kiosk knows your phone was near it at 11:00 a Tuesday in March.

The payphone knew nothing. That was the whole point.



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SMALL GRID THEORY

— S. REYES

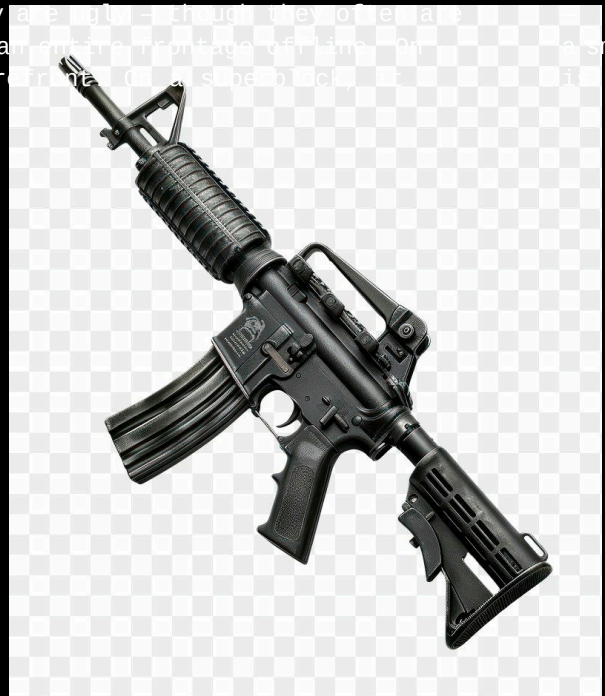
SMALL GRID THEORY

— S. REYES



"/ "SMALL BLOCK GRID, CENTRAL DISTRICT

Large blocks produce dead zones. Not because they are ugly—though they often are—but because a single failed anchor tenant takes a disproportionate definition on a small block, one failed storefront is one failed storefront. On a small block, one failed storefront is four hundred feet of blank wall.

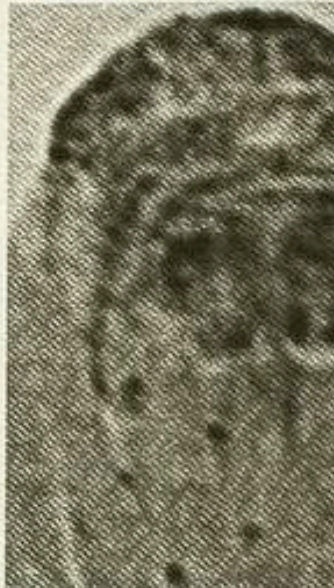


Density is not the variable.
Granularity is the variable.



city onto a large-block grid by adding mixed-use
can add a coffee shop on the ground floor of a
700-foot-frontage building and it will feel like a
airport. Because it is.

The blocks have to be small first. Everything else
blocks. Jane Jacobs said this in 1961. We have spent
sixty years building the opposite.



TENANCE WORKERS

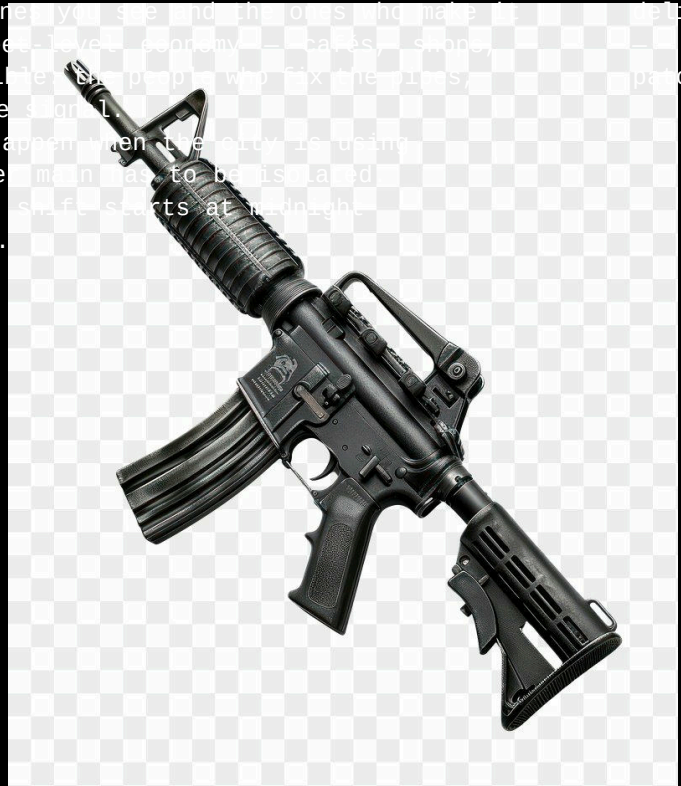
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— 038

THE MAINTENANCE WORKERS

— P. VOSS

Every city has two kinds of workers. The one you see and the ones who make it possible for you to see them. The street, the economy, the city, is only possible on a substrate that is mostly invisible. The people who fix the lights, patch the road, swap the transformer, re-hang the sign. They work at 2am because the work cannot happen when the city is using itself. The road has to be empty. The water main has to be isolated. The substation has to be de-energized. The shift starts at midnight and ends before anyone notices it happened.



"/ "SUBSTATION CREW, 2:30AM



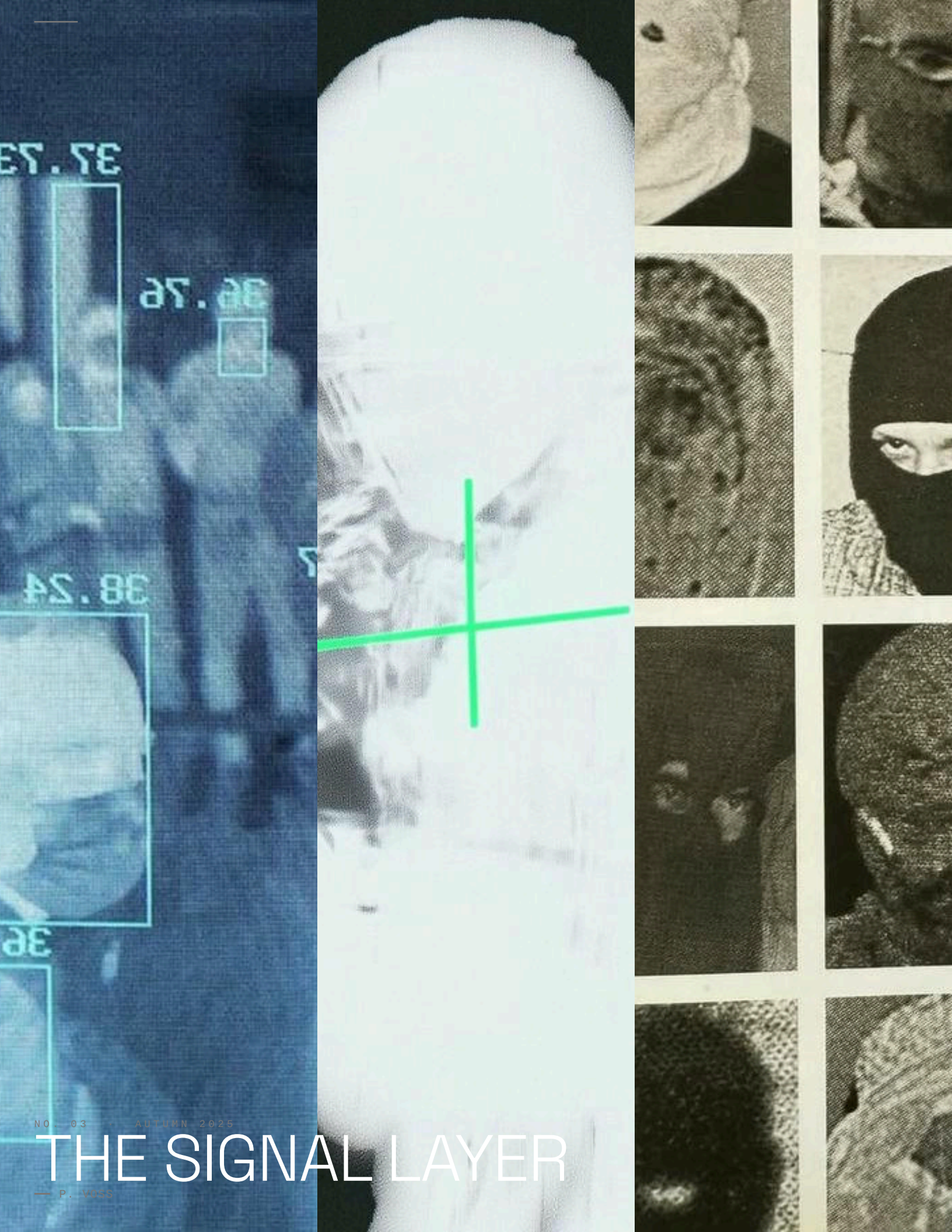
It is by design. The ideal maintenance event is one that nobody knows occurred. The pipe doesn't burst, so there's no story. The signal doesn't fail, so there's no backup. The transformer holds, so the hospital stays on.

INVISIBILITY AS SUCCESS METRIC

The KPI for infrastructure maintenance is the absence of events. Nothing happened. That is the goal. That is how you know it worked.

We have built an economy around visibility. We have built the physical world on top of a system whose best outcome is that you never think about it.





37.78

36.78

38.24

36

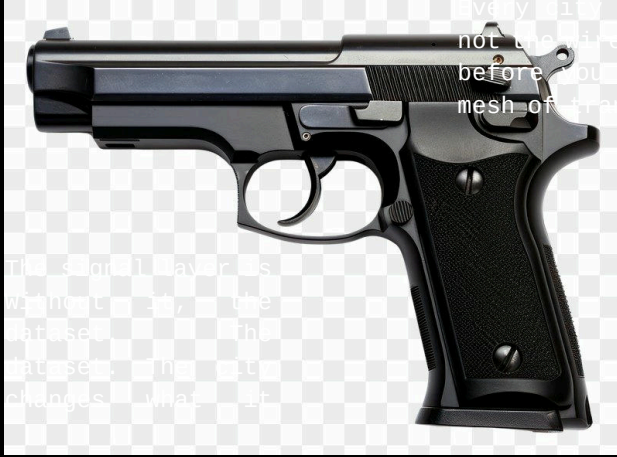
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THE SIGNAL LAYER

— P. VOSS

ARTICLE THE SIGNAL LAYER

— P. VOSS



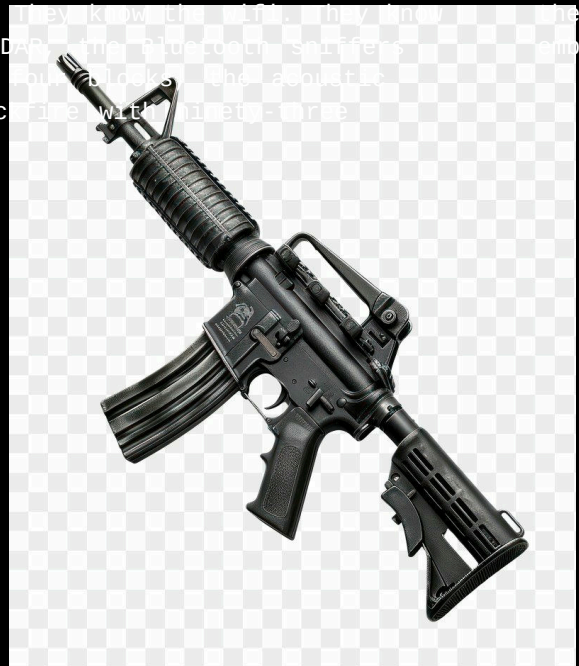
The signal layer is
where the city, the
buses, the streets,
the pedestrians, the
city changes what it

runs on a layer you cannot see. Not the pipes, not the roads — those are findable, mappable, orange-flagged before you dig. The signal layer is different. It is the mesh of transmissions that tells the traffic light what the car did three blocks away, that tells the transit authority the bus is running four minutes late, that tells the logistics platform the driver has paused.

where the city becomes legible to itself. The buses are just buses. With it, the buses are a dataset. The streets are a dataset. The pedestrians are a dataset. The city reads itself continuously and the reading does.

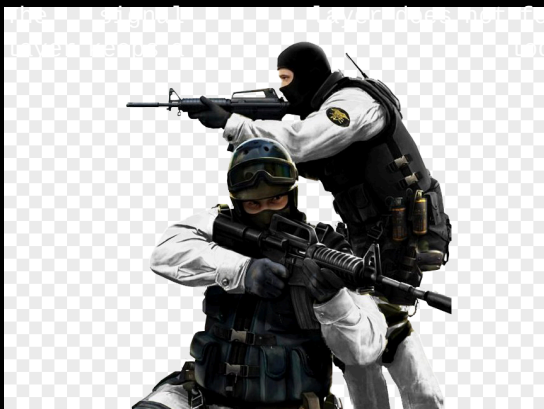
// "MESH NODE, LAMP POST ARRAY

Most people do not know the signal layer exists. They know cell signal. They do not know the mesh, the LIDAR in lamp posts, the license plate readers every inch of the city, the cameras that can tell a gunshot from a car back with 99 percent accuracy.

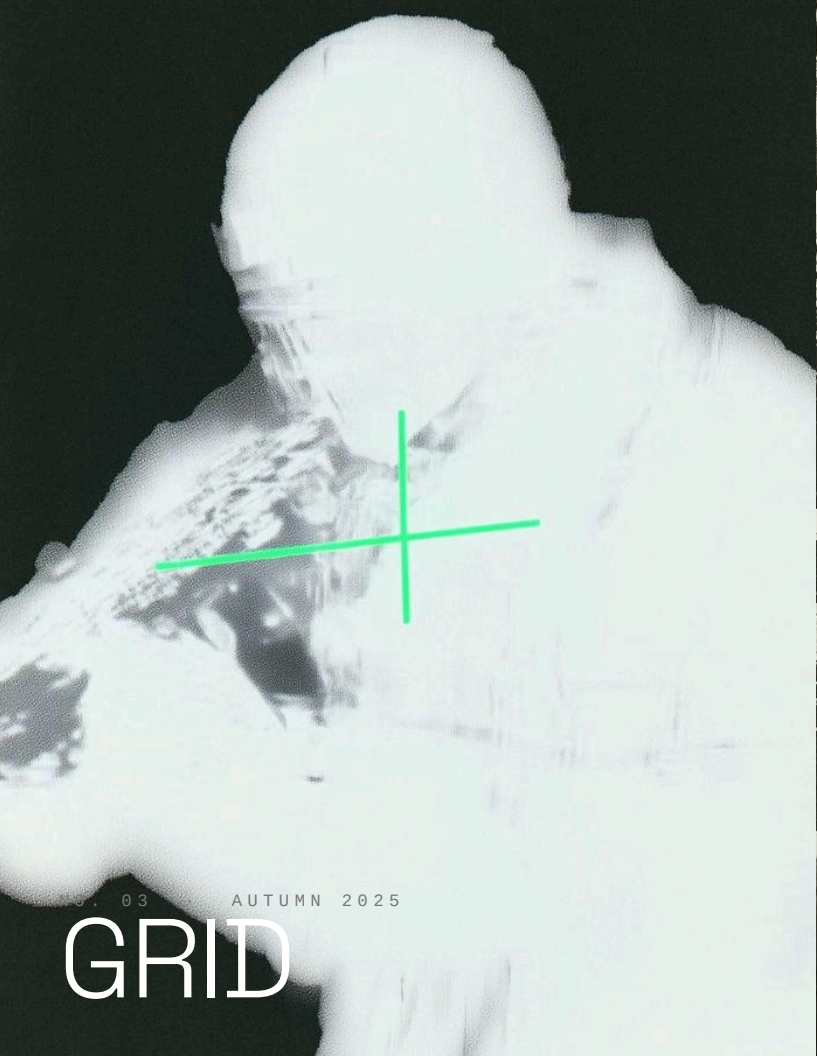


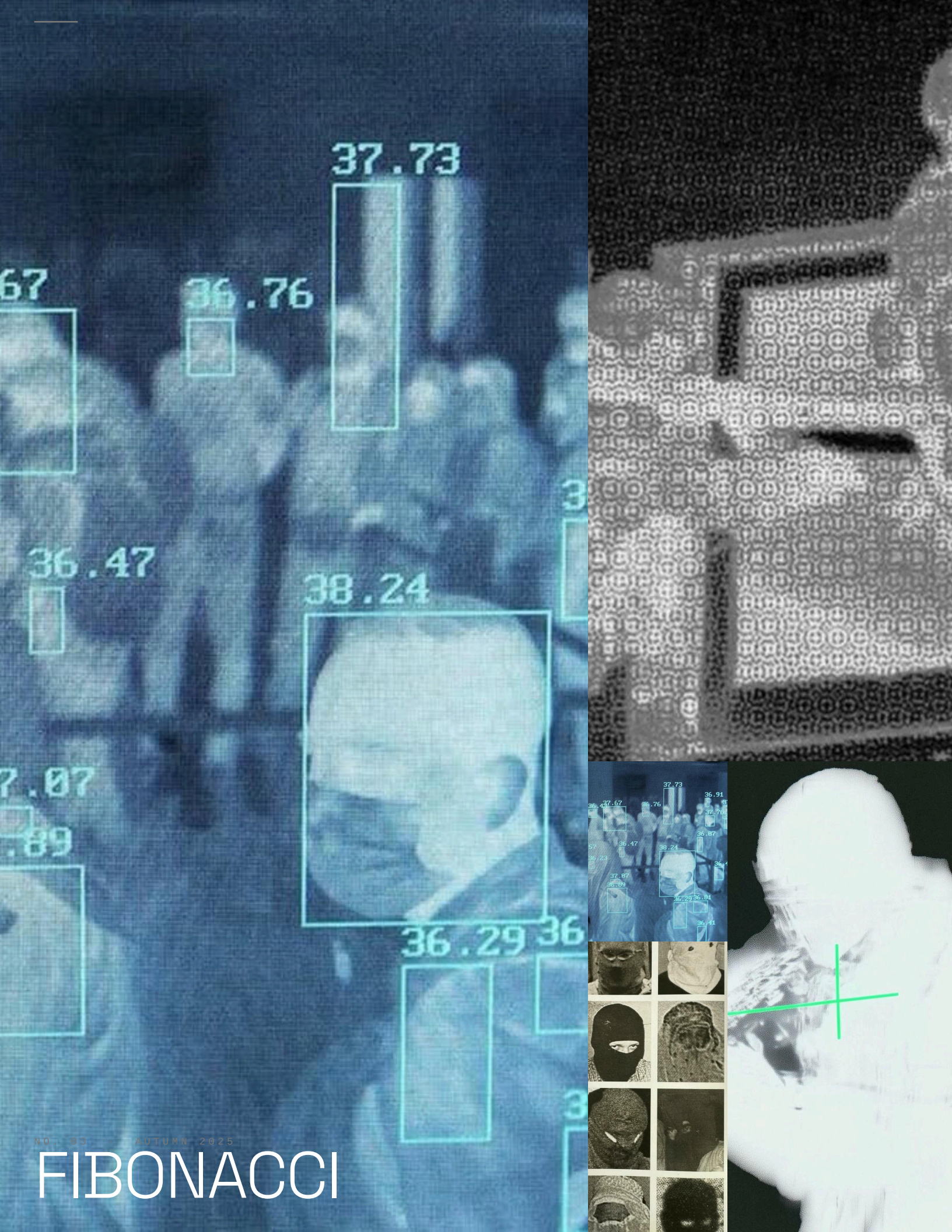
WHAT THE SIGNAL LAYER KNOWS

Where you were. How fast you moved. What device you carried. Whether you stopped. For how long. Whether you stopped at that spot before.



target. The buses forget. The people forget. The signal layer never forgets.





37.73

67

36.76

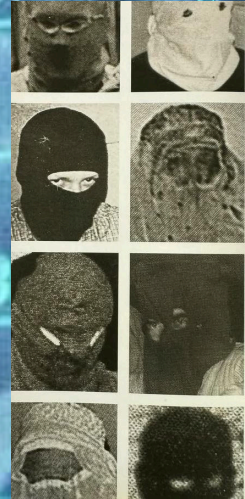
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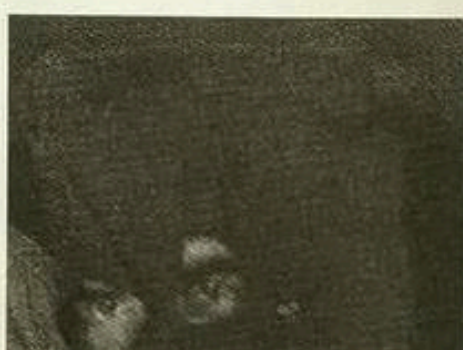
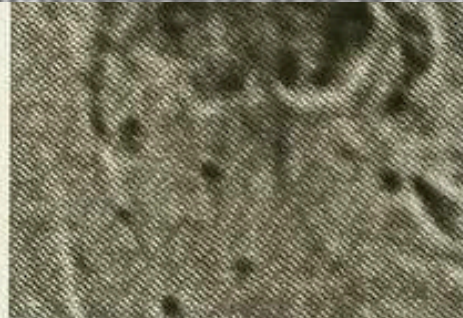
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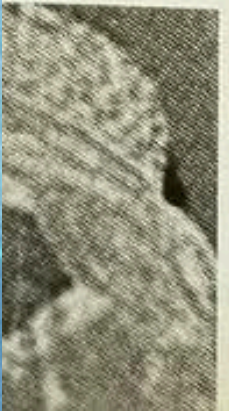
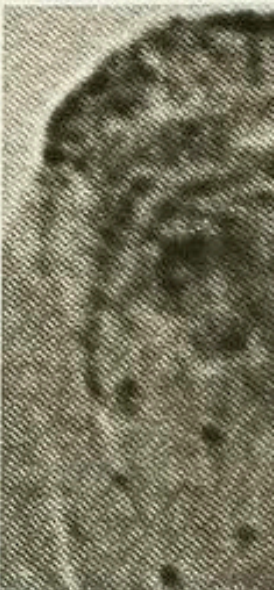
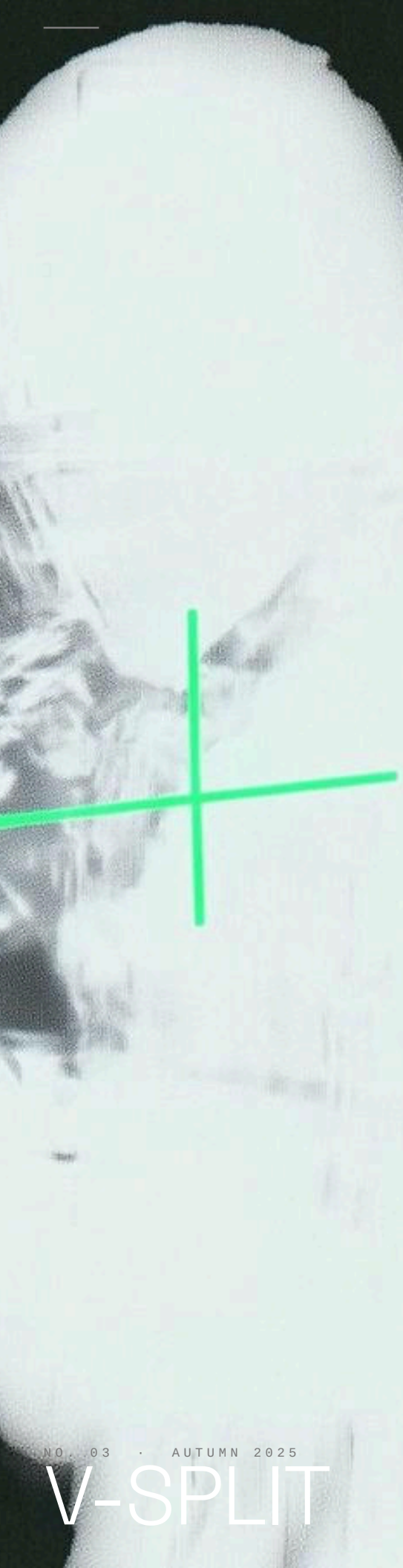
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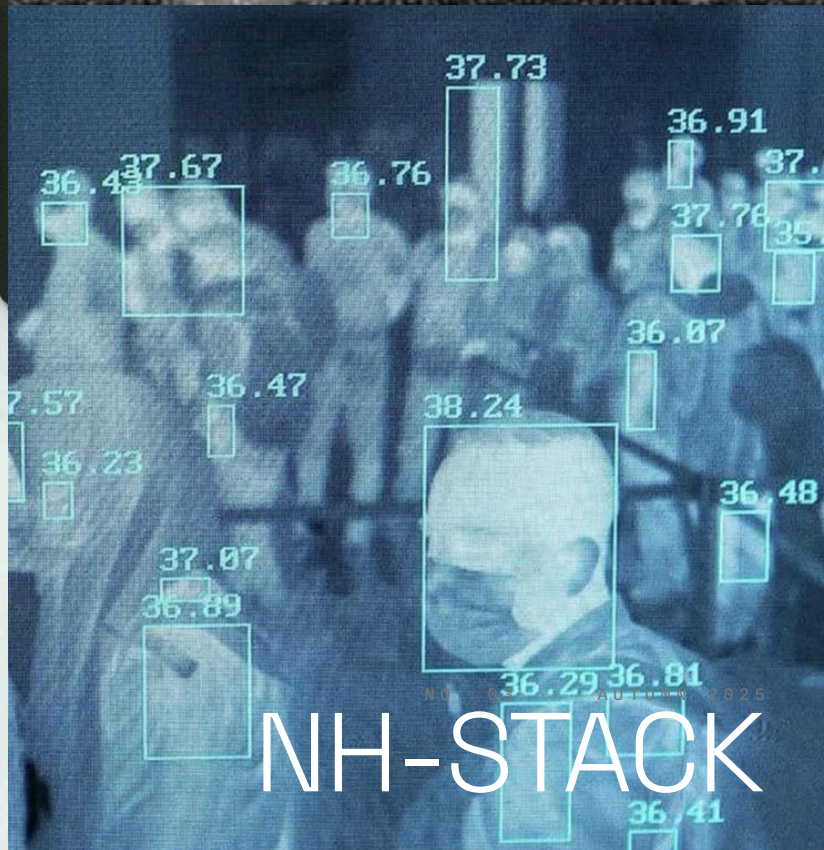
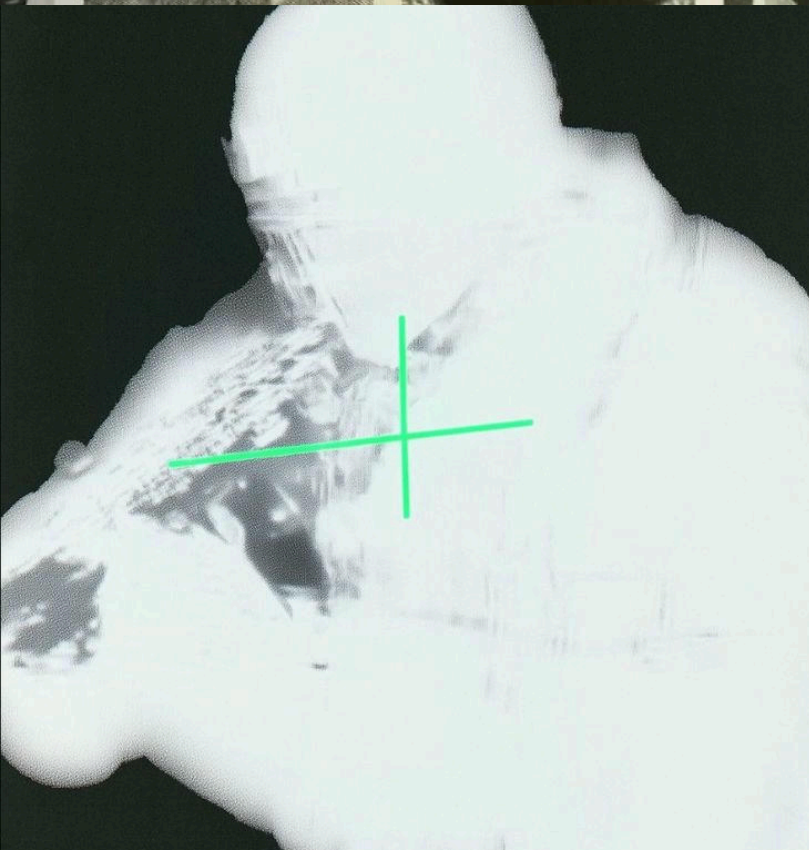
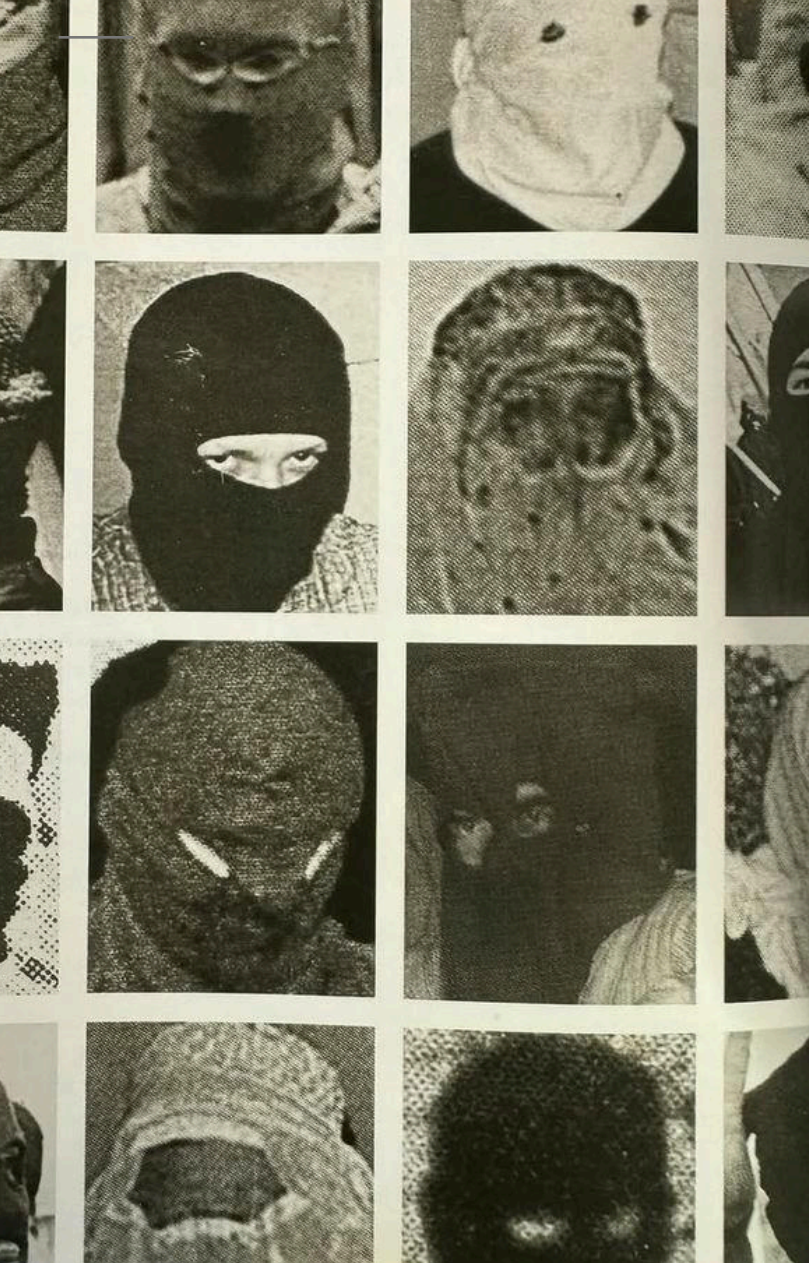
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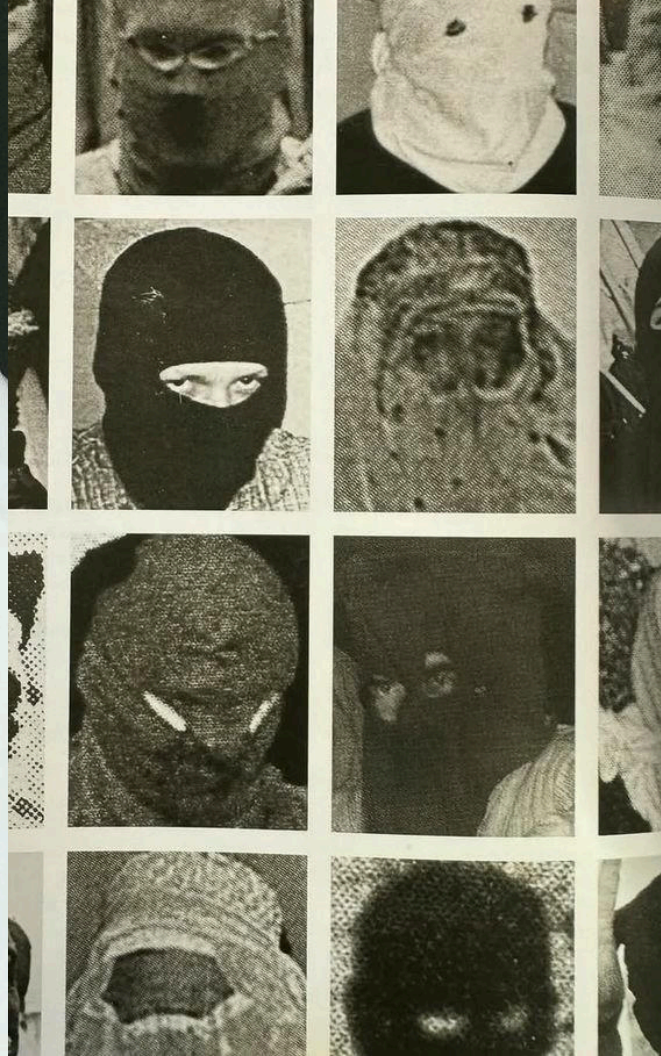


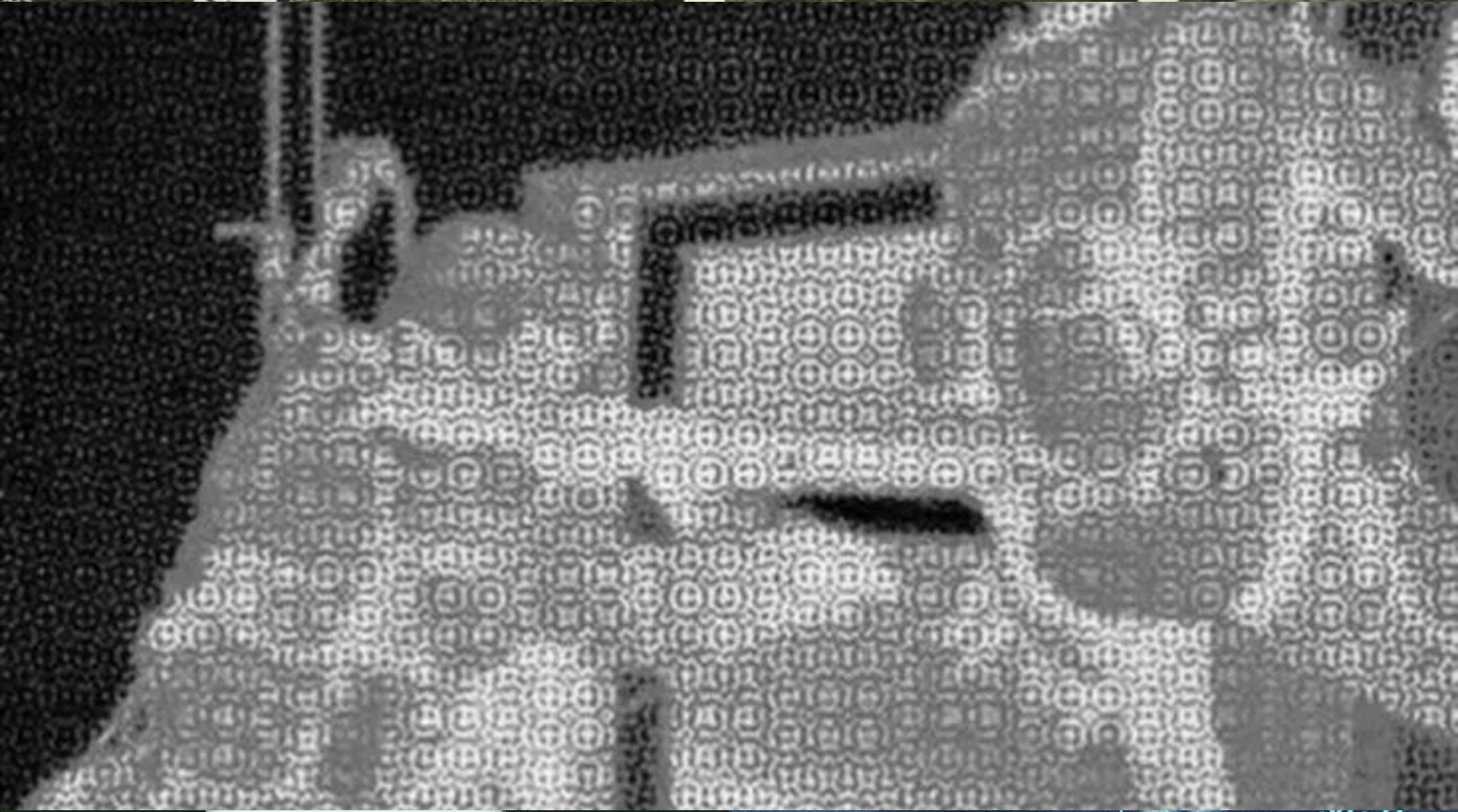
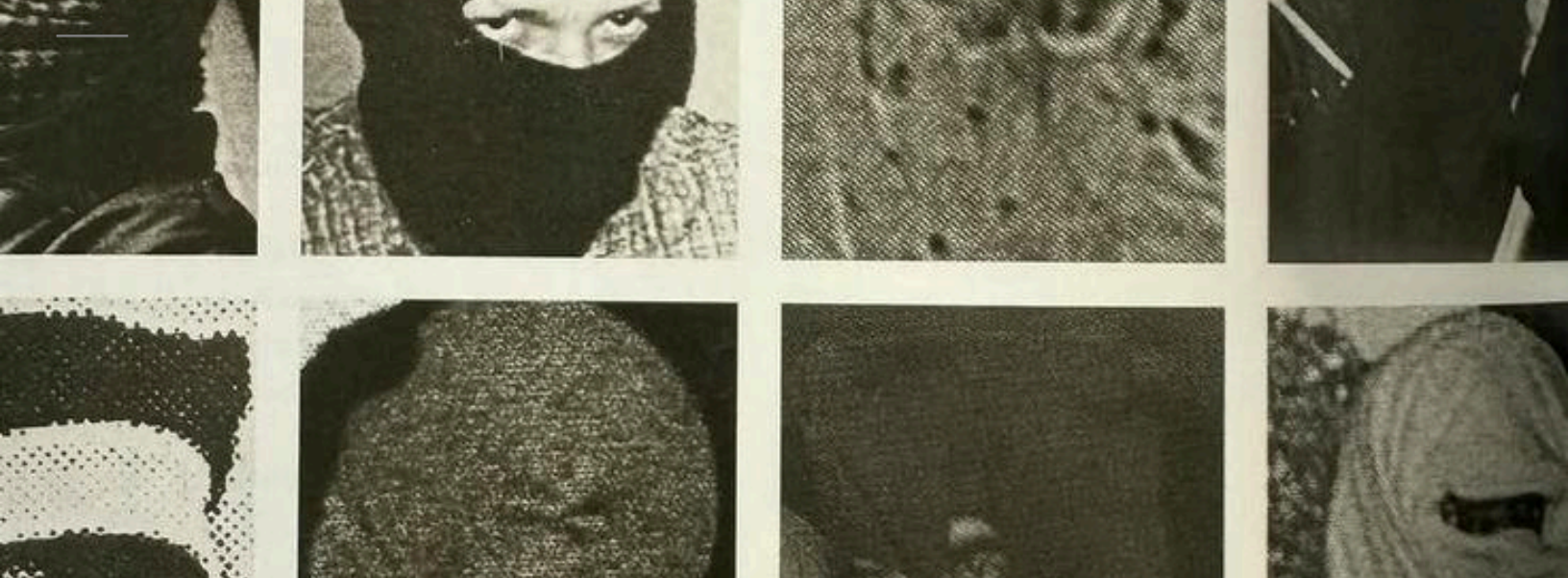






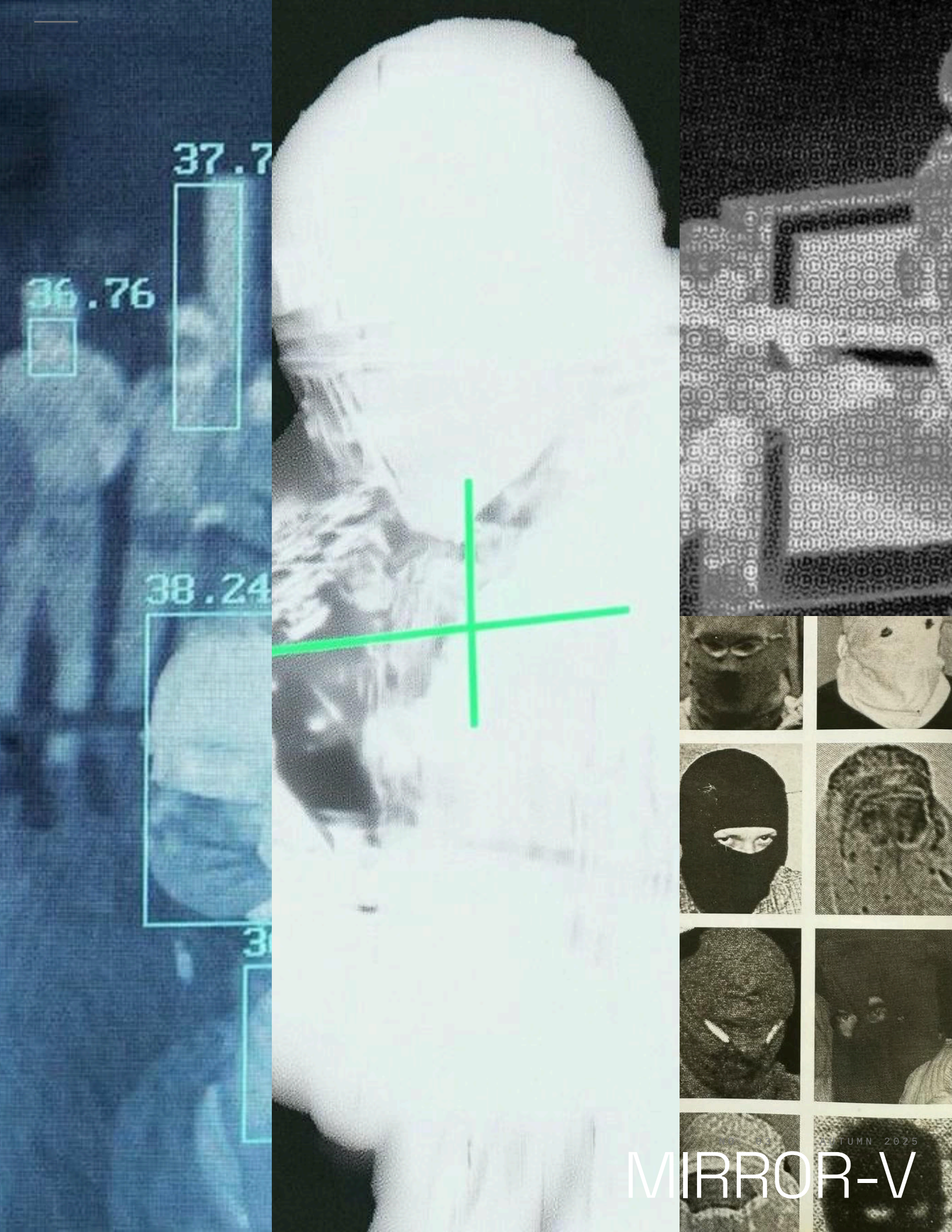
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MIRROR-H



36.76

37.7

38.24

3

MIRROR-V

TUMN 2025

ON THE BUS PIECE (ISSUE 02) ____

You said the bus is slow because of choices, not physics. I've been thinking about this for three weeks. You're right and I hate it. — **J.W., Chicago**

CORRECTION ____

The Houston light rail does not go to the airport. We stated that it did. It does not. We regret this. — **the editors**

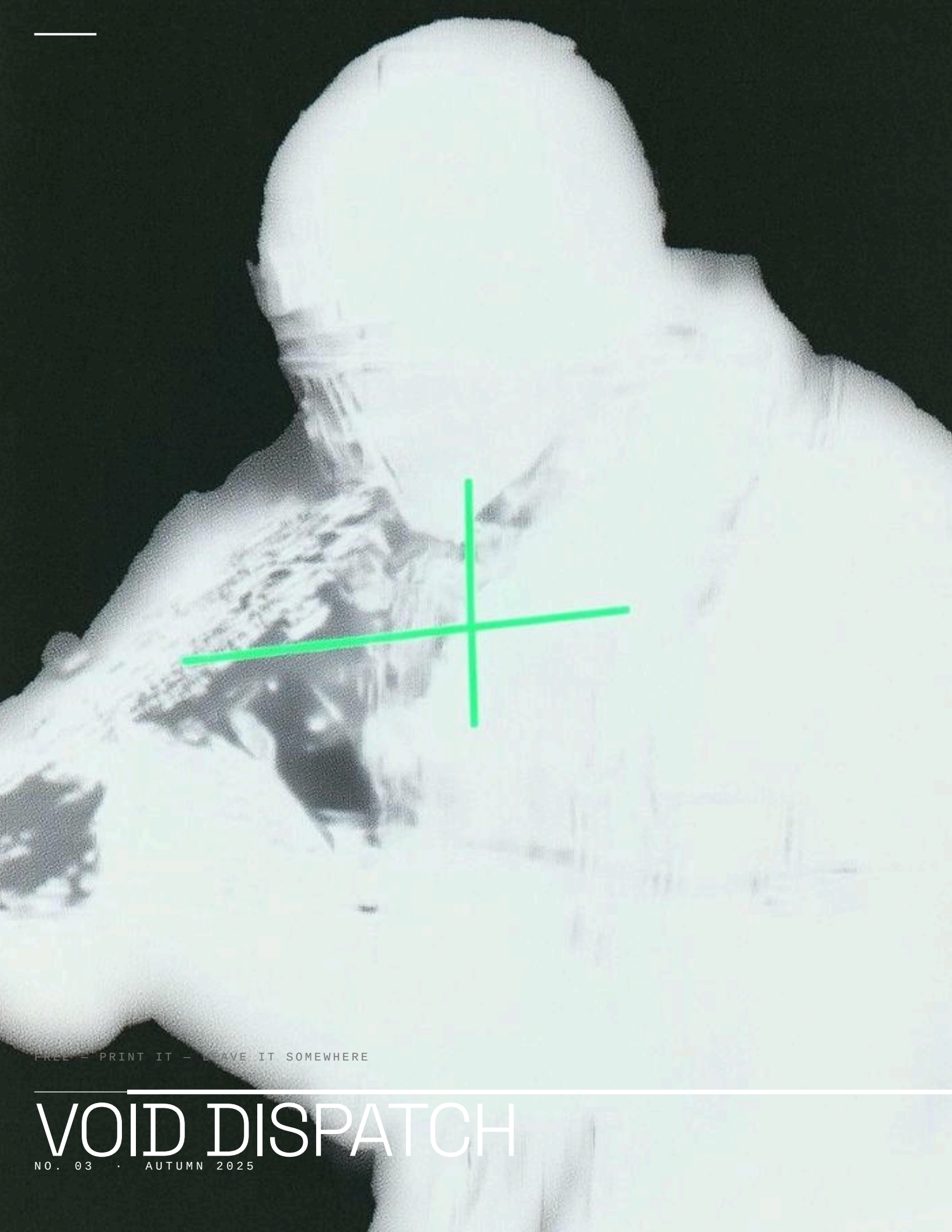
SUBMISSIONS ____

800 words or fewer. No pitches. Send it done. Plaintext. — **void-dispatch@proton.me**

Next issue: infrastructure that fights back. Submissions open. 800 words or fewer. No pitches. Send it done.

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